

TidyTuesday Week 34

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Wednesday 19th August, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the corner of the internet where we throw two unrelated economic time series into a blender, hit "regress," and pretend we're doing science. This week was a modest two-day affair, which is to say we generated exactly two chances to embarrass ourselves and, frankly, delivered on both.

Monday, August 18, gave us the crown jewel of trend-mirages: a discontinued index of hospital and nursing-home output pitted against house prices in Nassau and Suffolk County, New York. The raw regression came out swinging – an R-squared of 0.60, a p-value with more zeros after the decimal than I care to count, the whole nine yards. For one glorious moment I nearly believed that the fate of Long Island real estate is written in the ledgers of nursing homes. And then we detrended it, and the entire relationship evaporated like a puddle in July. R-squared cratered to 0.08, the p-value ballooned to a limp 0.23, and the "significant" link revealed itself for what it always was: two things that both went up over the years because that's what a lot of things do. Textbook drift. Chef's kiss. This is the exact species of correlation this project exists to catch and gently mock.

Tuesday, August 19, mercifully spared us the whole rise-and-fall drama by simply not delivering much of anything. U.S. Government Grants Excluding Military versus a mining output price deflator managed a raw p-value of 0.08 – not even significant by the usual standards, just close enough to make you squint. Once detrended, it slumped to a p-value of 0.53 and an R-squared of 0.016, which is statistician-speak for "these two numbers have never met and would not recognize each other on the street." A blessedly boring result, and honestly a relief after Monday's emotional rollercoaster.

The obligatory reminder, because my lawyer insists: these series are paired at random, nobody is claiming that hospital output moves house prices or that government grants haunt the mining sector, and the entire point of the exercise is that spurious correlation is the default setting of the universe, not some rare anomaly. This week the detrending did its job with flawless consistency by demolishing everything, which means we found zero genuine relationships and had a lovely time doing it. See you next week for more of the same.

2 Date: 2026-08-18

Series ID: USHSPTLNRSQGSP

This series is titled Quantity Indexes for Real Gross Domestic Product by Industry: Private Industries: Educational Services, Health Care, and Social Assistance: Health Care and Social Assistance: Hospitals and Nursing and Residential Care Facilities for United States (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2009=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2016-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS35004Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Nassau County-Suffolk County, NY (MSAD) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1975-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 21.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS35004Q	R-squared:	0.595
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.573
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	26.47
Date:	Tue, 18 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	6.80e-05
Time:	12:24:41	Log-Likelihood:	-101.38
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	206.8
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	208.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-202.2530	81.976	-2.467	0.024	-374.478	-30.028
value_fred_USHSPTLNRSQGSP	4.5554	0.885	5.145	0.000	2.695	6.416

Omnibus:	3.374	Durbin-Watson:	0.176
Prob(Omnibus):	0.185	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.734
Skew:	0.872	Prob(JB):	0.255
Kurtosis:	2.515	Cond. No.	837.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

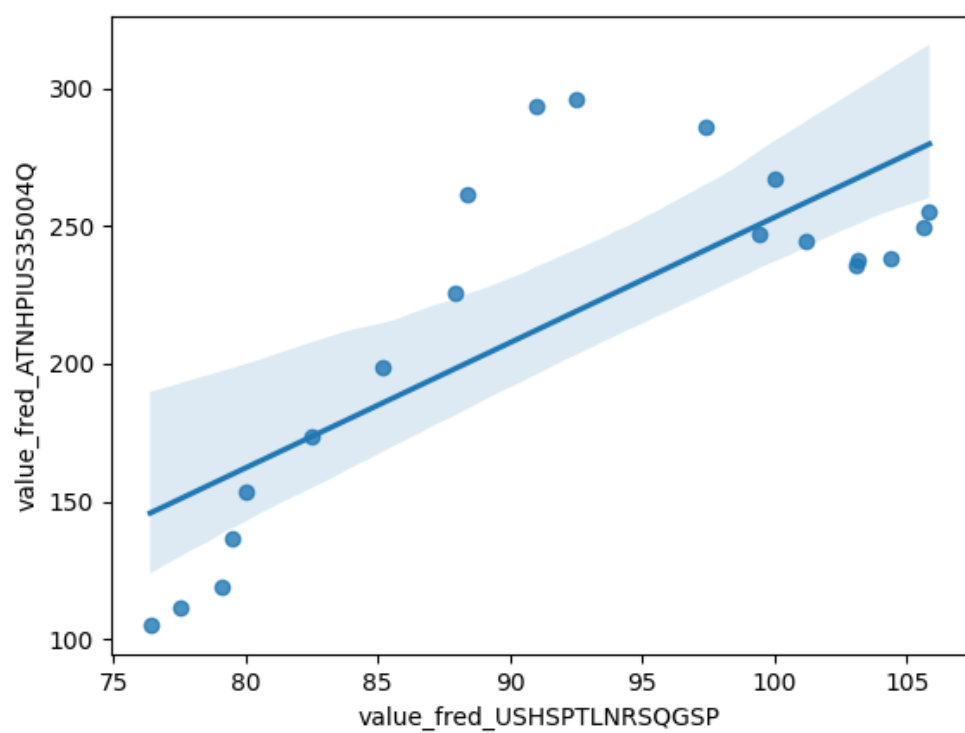


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-18

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS35004Q_detrended	R-squared:	0.079
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.028
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.551
Date:	Tue, 18 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.229
Time:	12:24:41	Log-Likelihood:	-101.26
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	206.5
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	208.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.868e-11	9.015	2.07e-12	1.000	-18.941	18.941
value_fred_USHSPTLNRSQGSP_detrended	7.1907	5.773	1.246	0.229	-4.938	19.320

Omnibus:	3.498	Durbin-Watson:	0.209
Prob(Omnibus):	0.174	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.716
Skew:	0.887	Prob(JB):	0.257
Kurtosis:	2.669	Cond. No.	1.56

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

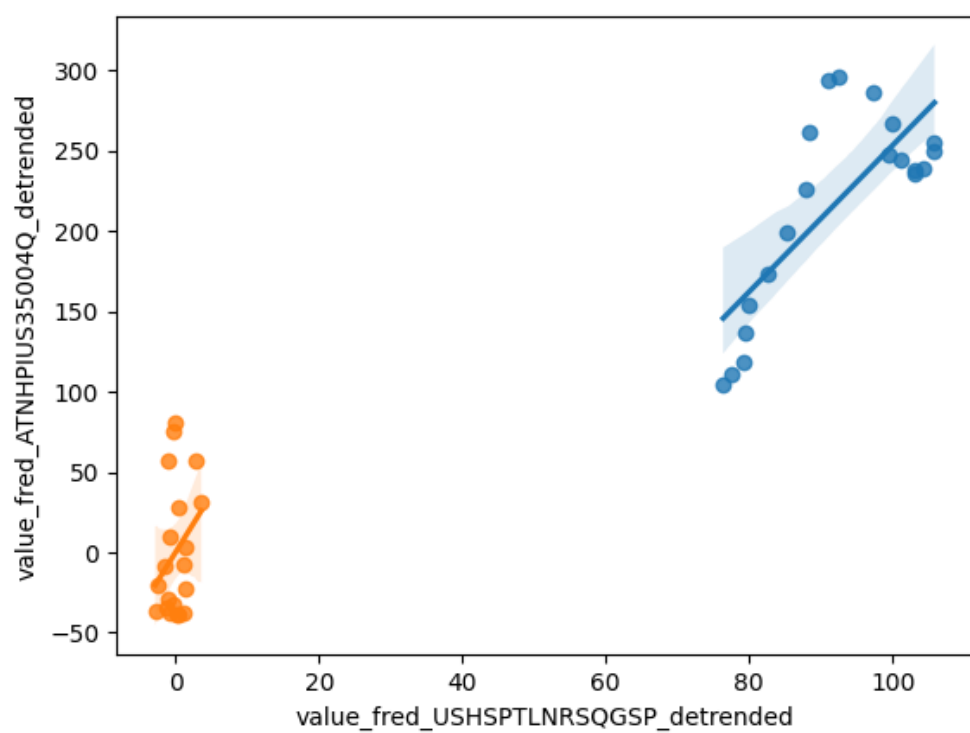


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-18

3 Date: 2026-08-19

Series ID: BOPGG

This series is titled U.S. Government Grants Excluding Military (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2014-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IPUBN212T051000000

This series is titled Sectoral Output Price Deflator for Mining: Mining (Except Oil and Gas) (NAICS 212) in the United States and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Percent Change from Year Ago and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1988-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IPUBN212T051000000	R-squared:	0.117
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.082
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	3.328
Date:	Wed, 19 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0801
Time:	12:19:54	Log-Likelihood:	-85.697
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	175.4
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	178.0
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.3198	1.512	0.873	0.391	-1.794	4.434
value_fred_BOPGG	-0.3525	0.193	-1.824	0.080	-0.750	0.045

Omnibus:	2.801	Durbin-Watson:	0.785
Prob(Omnibus):	0.246	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.507
Skew:	0.532	Prob(JB):	0.471
Kurtosis:	3.454	Cond. No.	10.3

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

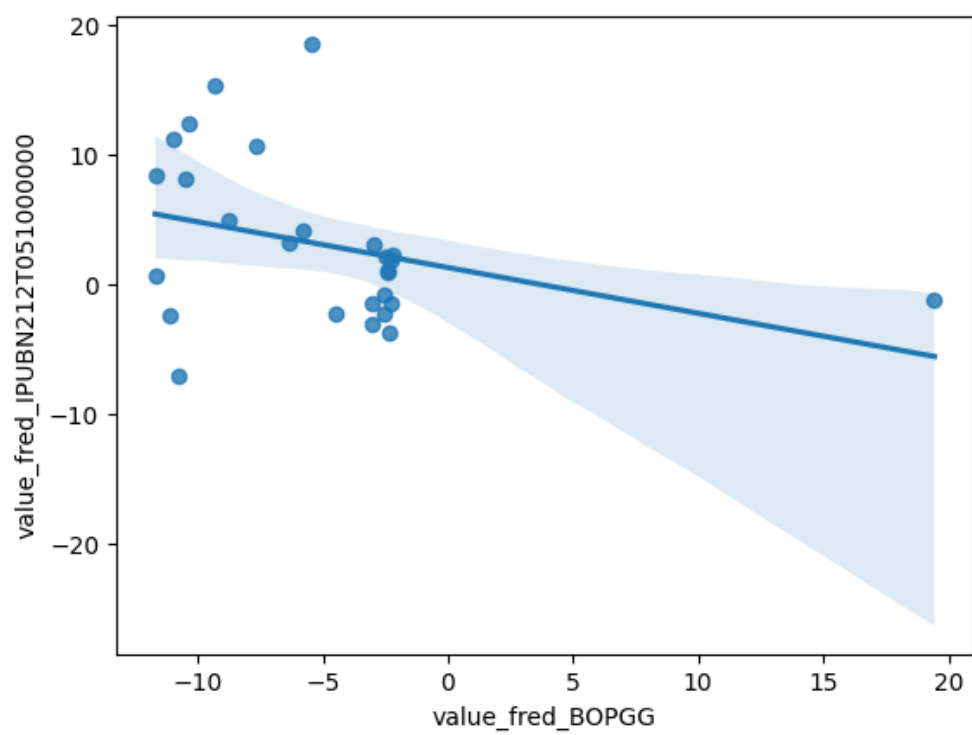


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-19

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IPUBN212T051000000_detrended	R-squared:	0.016
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.024
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.4017
Date:	Wed, 19 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.532
Time:	12:19:54	Log-Likelihood:	-85.249
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	174.5
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	177.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.801e-13	1.138	-1.58e-13	1.000	-2.343	2.343
value_fred_BOPGG_detrended	-0.1728	0.273	-0.634	0.532	-0.734	0.389

Omnibus:	2.027	Durbin-Watson:	0.686
Prob(Omnibus):	0.363	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.803
Skew:	0.236	Prob(JB):	0.669
Kurtosis:	3.700	Cond. No.	4.17

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

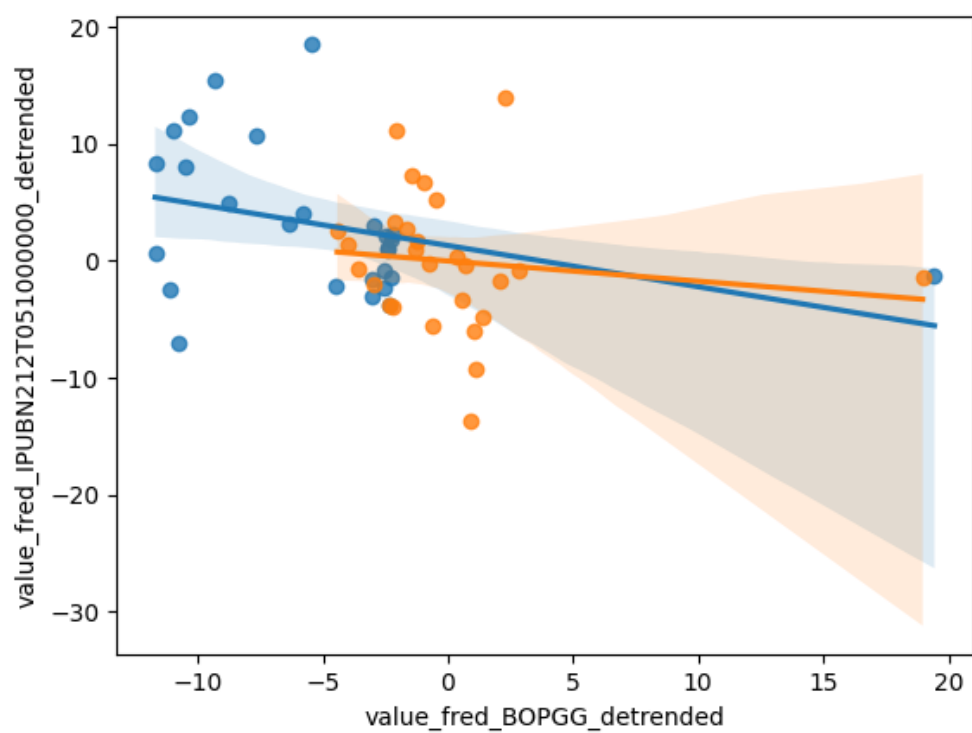


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-19